KNECK OFFICIAL

English — Paper 2

101/2 • ORIGINAL REVISION SET 01 • 2 hours 30 minutes • 80 marks

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Independent KCSE-style practice. Not issued, endorsed or predicted by KNEC. These are original questions, not leaked or past official papers. Component numbering is checked against the KNEC 2026 timetable. A teacher should review these practice materials before formal classroom assessment.

CANDIDATE INSTRUCTIONS

Answer all questions. Read the supplied original texts. The literary extract is an original skills exercise, not an excerpt from a prescribed set text.

Use a separate answer booklet. Show working where appropriate. The marking guidance begins after the END OF QUESTIONS page; do not consult it until you finish. Practical and project components require the stated equipment and teacher supervision, not merely a printed worksheet.

SUPPLIED MATERIAL / RESOURCE

RESOURCE A — WATER

At first, the new water tank beside Mwangaza Secondary School was regarded as a gift that would solve every problem. During the first week, students left taps running while they laughed with friends. The tank had been filled by a tanker, and its tall sides made the water seem inexhaustible. By Friday, however, the kitchen had no water for lunch.

The environmental club decided that blaming the younger students would achieve little. Its members measured the amount of water used by each department. They found a leaking pipe behind the dining hall and discovered that washing under a running tap used far more water than washing in a basin. They displayed their findings without naming individuals.

Some students objected to the club's proposal to install push taps. They argued that another device would simply break. A caretaker therefore repaired one existing tap and invited the students to compare its daily water use with that of an unrepaired tap. The demonstration changed the discussion. What had sounded like a punishment now looked like a practical saving.

The school still needed money for repairs. Rather than organise an expensive ceremony, the club held a repair afternoon. A local plumber donated two hours of labour, while parents provided a few fittings. Students recorded the work so that future club members could maintain the system.

By the next term, consumption had fallen, but the club refused to declare the problem permanently solved. Its chairperson said that conservation was a habit, not an event. Every new class would have to learn why a small leak mattered. The tank had not changed in size; the community had changed the way it valued what was inside.

RESOURCE B — THE LEDGER (ORIGINAL FICTION)

“You cannot publish the list,” the head clerk told Nali. He placed a hand over the ledger, but she had already copied the figures. Outside, residents waited for an explanation of the missing bursary funds.

“I can publish the amount each office received,” Nali replied. “I will not publish the children's names.”

The clerk looked at her again. “People want a villain.”

“Then we must give them evidence, not a convenient stranger.”

For a moment, the room was silent except for the printer. It had stopped halfway through a page, leaving a blank strip where the totals should have been. The clerk pulled the paper free and smoothed it on the

table.
“My sister applied for that bursary,” he said quietly.
“Then help me check the entries.”
He moved his hand from the ledger. Nali passed him a pencil, and together they began with the first column.

RESOURCE C — ANOTHER MORNING (ORIGINAL POEM)
At dawn I swept the borrowed room,
And folded yesterday's defeat;
The road still wore its coat of dust,
Yet hope put sandals on my feet.

I had no map of easy days,
No promise sewn into my sleeve;
But every door I knocked upon
Taught stubborn hands how to believe.

COMPREHENSION

Read Resource A.

1. (a) Why did students initially waste water? (2) (b) Identify two findings of the audit. (4) (c) Explain why the caretaker used a demonstration. (3) (d) Explain “conservation was a habit, not an event”. (3) (e) Identify two ways the repair afternoon reduced costs. (4) (f) Give meanings in context: inexhaustible; consumption. (2) (g) Supply a suitable title. (2) [20 marks]

LITERARY APPRECIATION

Read Resource B.

2. (a) Place the extract in its immediate situation without inventing events beyond the passage. (4) (b) Explain two traits of Nali with evidence. (6) (c) Discuss two themes. (6) (d) Identify and explain one symbolic detail. (3) (e) Explain the change in the clerk's behaviour. (4) (f) Rewrite “You cannot publish the list,” the head clerk told Nali in reported speech. (2) [25 marks]

POETRY

Read Resource C.

3. (a) Identify the speaker's situation. (3) (b) Explain the message. (4) (c) Identify two instances of personification and explain their effects. (6) (d) Describe the tone with evidence. (3) (e) Explain “folded yesterday's defeat”. (2) (f) Give the rhyme relationship in lines 2 and 4 of each stanza. (2) [20 marks]

GRAMMAR

Answer as instructed.

4. (a) Rewrite using “unless”: If you do not revise, you may forget the method. (2) (b) Change to passive: The club repaired the taps. (2) (c) Combine using a relative clause: This is the plumber. He donated his

time. (2) (d) Correct: Each of the students have a booklet. (2) (e) Supply a question tag: They have finished, ___ (1) (f) Fill prepositions: interested ___ science; responsible ___ the files. (2) (g) Punctuate: nali asked where is the ledger (2) (h) Give the comparative of good and plural of analysis. (2) [15 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

MARKING GUIDANCE

English • Paper 2 • Set 01

Suggested answers and assessment guidance, not an official marking scheme. Accept equivalent correct reasoning, valid examples and properly justified alternative methods. Marks for an item must not exceed its printed allocation. For essays use relevant textual evidence and the rubric; no plot summary alone.

COMPREHENSION

1. (20 marks) a Tank appeared inexhaustible/gift assumed sufficient (2). b Leaking pipe and running-tap washing consumed more than basin (4). c Evidence tested objections and showed practical saving rather than punishment (3). d Requires repeated responsible behaviour/maintenance and education, not one campaign (3). e Donated labour and parent fittings/no costly ceremony, any two explained (4). f Impossible to use up; amount used (2). g Relevant concise title, e.g. Learning to Value Water (2).

LITERARY APPRECIATION

2. (25 marks) a Bursary records questioned; residents wait; Nali has copied figures; clerk initially resists publication (4). b Principled/evidence-led/protective of privacy/persuasive; any two trait plus evidence plus explanation (6). c Accountability and privacy/fairness/cooperation; two supported developed points (6). d Blank totals symbolise missing accountability/incomplete truth, or ledger as evidence (3). e Personal connection through sister, Nali's fair approach and invitation to verify move him from obstruction to cooperation (4). f The head clerk told Nali that she could not publish the list (2).

POETRY

3. (20 marks) a Person facing past setbacks and uncertain future but continuing to seek opportunity (3). b Persistence creates hope despite lack of guarantees; develop 2 points (4). c Road wears coat; hope puts sandals; doors/hands may be interpreted with justification; two supported explanations (6). d Resolute/hopeful despite hardship, evidence from continued knocking/hope (3). e Puts past failure aside/prepares fresh effort (2). f Defeat/feet and sleeve/believe rhyme (2).

GRAMMAR

4. (15 marks) a Unless you revise, you may forget the method (2). b The taps were repaired by the club (2). c This is the plumber who donated his time (2). d Each of the students has a booklet (2). e haven't they? (1). f in; for (2). g Nali asked, “Where is the ledger?” (2). h better; analyses (2).

REVISION CHECK

Mark your work, list three misconceptions, revise those topics and attempt the incorrect questions again without the guide. These topics are revision priorities, not a forecast of the real examination.

Paper/component reference: https://www.knec.ac.ke/wp-content/uploads/2026/02/2026-KCSE-Timetable.pdf